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Forum Review: NFS Shift nmenon

Right Off the Assembly Line

Join Date: Oct 2008 • Location: Cochin • Posts: 37

I got my hands on NFS Shift original version from my cousin.

Difficulty settings: Medium, TC, ABS, Stability Control, Steering Assist on, Auto Gearbox.

It seems to have borrowed elements from 3 games - Race Driver: GRID, Juiced: Hot Import Nights, and Pro Street. It also is probably the first NFS game to have the legendary Nurburgring (Nordschleife 20.74km) circuit, as far as I know its only Gran Turismo that used to have it. The damage model is similar to GRID but on a lower scale with the extreme damage being very rare. However the effects on the driver are stunning. Brushing the barriers gives blurred vision, head on impacts elicit an 'Ooof' and a temporary blackout and reaction on the radio. It also has the return of the in cockpit view where realistic head movements are mimicked by the camera. Car handling is mixed with the TC, ABS, stability control preventing you from countering a skid unless very careful, strangely front wheel drive cars also tend to have loose tails resulting in slides which are nasty. The AI reacts to your driving, barge someone off the road and they will ram you back, go through cleanly they'll show you some respect. There are rivals to be



challenged if you reach certain levels. Driving style dictates the invitational events available after driver level ups. Precise Clean driving results in more Hot Lap races while Aggressive driving results in more Eliminator races (Elimination of the last placed person after a set timer expires). The Start of a race look like the ones you see on TV; Ladies with Boards (NFS icon on them instead of numbers), mechanics talking to the drivers etc, radio from the pits providing last minute info and instructions). The car collection is pretty awesome with the possibility of in depth tuning which is similar to the options in Colin McRae: DiRT. Unfortunately, no Underground 2 style of Dyno and ECU tuning.

Personal Ratings

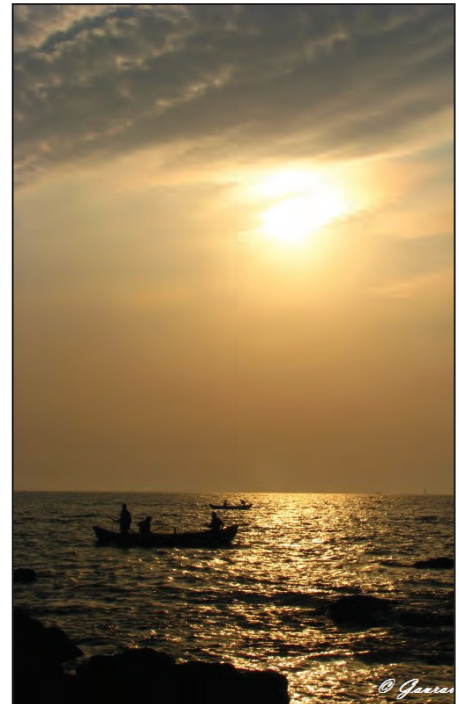
Graphics : 4/5 (GRID is better)

Gameplay : 3.5/5 (Car handling on the keyboard is temperamental, drifting is very difficult, else I'd give it 4 or 4.5)

Audio : 4/5 (car sounds great, effects such as the flexing of the armco barriers making metal sheet like noise, limited songs sadly)

Car Collection : 4.5/5

Overall: 4/5

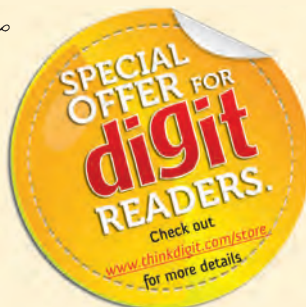


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